

Pre-Board Examination – 2079

Class : XII

Subject: C. English (0041)

Full Marks: 75

Time: 3 hrs.

SET B

Pass Marks: 30

Candidates are required to give their answers in their own words as far as practicable. The figures in the margin indicate full marks.

1. Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

The assertion that water has always been the essence of life is nothing new. Water comes in many forms: spring water, sea and river water, rainwater, and fog and dew water. Yet water is becoming scarce and this scarcity is becoming a very real worry for governments all around the world. The reality is that one of the main obstacles to the economic development of a particular country is its lack of an adequate supply of fresh water. Current figures show that an inhabitant of a wealthy, modern town consumes 100-400 litres of water daily. In some developing countries the amount of water consumed does not exceed 20-30 litres per day. Rich or poor, annual water consumption has continued to grow, increasing fourfold over the last 50 years.

The world's fresh water supplies are drawn from a number of sources. The largest cache of the estimated 35 million km³ fresh water reserve is located in glaciers and snow. The amount contained in these 'storehouses' has been estimated to be around 24 million km³. Ground water is also a big contributor to the world's fresh water supplies amounting to an estimated 10.5 million km³. Considering that the total volume of water, salt and fresh, is estimated to be around 400 million km³ it can be clearly seen that the amount of fresh water available in the world is only the proverbial 'drop in the bucket'. Artesian wells, rivers and lakes only account for about 0.1 and 0.5 million km³ respectively, all of which include atmospheric precipitation such as rain and snow.

Since water is such an important commodity, various attempts to acquire stores of it have been tried with varying degrees of success. The question of what are the alternative water sources available to us today is not an easy one to answer but is certainly worthy of our best efforts to find one. One such area of interest has been desalination – the turning of salt water into drinkable water. As there is much more salt water on the earth than dry land, the idea of using desalinated seawater seems a logical one. However, some estimates put the annual quantity of desalinated water at only around ten cubic kilometres

– a tiny amount given the amount of sea water available. In parts of Senegal, for example, the greenhouse effect has been one way to desalinate seawater whereby the salt in the water is separated from the water through a process of evaporation. As part of the process, water vapour forms on large panes of glass at outside air temperature and is transported via gravity into drums. This method yields only a few cubic meters per day of fresh water but is surprisingly energy efficient. In larger scale production however, the energy efficiency plummets. The best systems burn at least a tonne of fossil fuel to produce approximately one hundred cubic metres of fresh water. This amounts to almost \$ 1 per cubic metre – a considerable cost.

Although there are several different areas from which water can be sourced, paradoxically the most extensive are the most difficult to tap. The atmosphere, for example, contains vast amounts of fresh water composed of 2% condensed water in the form of clouds and 98% water vapour. The vastness of this water source is comparable to the renewable liquid water resources of all inhabited lands. The amounts are easy to calculate, but being able and knowing how to economically obtain this water in liquid form is most challenging. One approach in drawing water from the atmosphere is fog nets. Places such as the coastal deserts of West Africa and areas of Chile and Peru have favourable condensation conditions. In these areas, ocean humidity condenses in the form of fog on the mid-range mountains (over 500m). This fog composed of droplets of suspended water can be collected in nets. In the 1960s, a University in Northern Chile conducted the first major experiments with fog nets. Drawing on the knowledge gained from these experiments, further testing was

done which culminated in one village using fog nets to yield a healthy daily average of 11,000 litres of water. On a smaller scale, fog-collecting nets have recently been used in the Canary Islands and Namibia.

Unfortunately, due to its need for a combination of several factors, fog is not readily available. Dew however appears far more frequently and is less subject to the constraints of climate and geography. In order for dew to form there needs to be some humidity in the air and a reasonably clear sky. Many hot areas of countries that suffer from a lack of water such as the Sahel region of Northern Africa for example, experience significant quantities of dew. When the temperature is lowered over a short space of time by ten degrees or so, the water-harvesting possibilities from the air yield an amazing ten grams of water from each cubic meter of air – significant drops in air temperature make for greater yields. Unlike fog, dew formation can occur even in a relatively dry atmosphere, such as a desert. All it takes is for the right mix of temperatures between the earth and the air to combine and dew formation occurs.

A. Choose the best answer: a, b, c, or d

[5×1 = 5]

1. As a method of obtaining fresh water, fog
 - a) forms best when the air is dry.
 - b) is easier to collect than dew.
 - c) is being tried in a large-scale way in Senegal.
 - d) is not easy to collect.
2. Small-scale ‘greenhouse effect’ desalination
 - a) uses a considerable amount of energy.
 - b) is the most effective way to obtain larger water reserves.
 - c) uses very little energy.
 - d) burns quite a lot of fossil fuel.
3. One of the largest stores of fresh water in the world is
 - a) rivers and lakes.
 - b) atmospheric rain and snow.
 - c) ground water.
 - d) artesian wells

4. The phrase 'one such area' in the paragraph 3 refers to...
 - a) The research scope of natural water sources exploration
 - b) No reference of prior exploration
 - c) alternative water sources
 - d) None of the above
5. 'Fog nets' are used to
 - a) Capture the fog
 - b) Convert fog into water
 - c) yield a healthy daily average of 11,000 liters of water
 - d) fog nets are of no use

B. Complete each sentence with the correct ending A-F from the options below. **[5×1 = 5]**

1. Turning salt water into drinking water.....
2. Large-scale fresh water production through evaporation.....
3. Water available in the atmosphere.....
4. The use of dew as a water source....
5. The amount of water collected from dew....

Options:

- A. is quite popular due to it not being too affected by temperature and location.
- B. is being tried via an evaporation process.
- C. is not energy efficient.
- D. is best for poorer countries.
- E. is made up of both clouds and water vapour.
- F. is increased when temperatures fall rapidly.

C. Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage? Mark the statement as *TRUE*, *FALSE*, OR *NOT GIVEN*.

[5×1 = 5]

- a) The amount of water consumed by wealthier countries is just as much as poorer countries.
- b) Glaciers, rivers, artesian wells and ground water are all sources of fresh water.
- c) Large bodies of water, such as the sea, have yielded the freshest water.
- d) The collection of water through the use of fog nets is becoming increasingly more popular around the world.
- e) If the sky is cloudy, dew will not form.

2. Write short answers to the following questions.

[5×2 = 10]

- a) Discuss *Facing Death* as a modern tragedy.
- b) Sketch the character of Famous Actress. (*A Matter of Husbands*)
- c) What is the moral of the story *The Treasure in the Forest*?
- d) Critically evaluate the speaker's 'feeling of intimate liberation' in the poem. (*I Was My Own Route*)
- e) Why is the poet contemplating over the absurdities of tumultuous time? (*Soft Storm*)

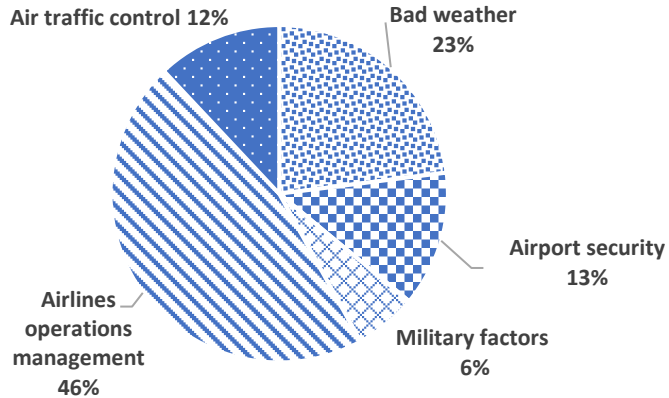
3. Write long answers to the following questions.

[2×5 = 10]

- a) Discuss the narrative techniques used in *The Half Closed Eyes of the Buddha and the Slowly Sinking Son* and *A Very Old Man with Enormous Wings*.
- b) Discuss the late eighteenth century Nepali society as depicted in the play. (*The Bull*)

4. The chart below shows the different reasons for flight delays in a particular Asian country in 2016. Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant. (150 words) [7]

Reasons for flight delays (2016)



5. One of your good friends is just confused about what s/he is supposed to do after appearing in the grade XII board examinations. Write a letter to your friend advising and suggesting some ways to utilize the time in the best ways. (180 words) [8]
6. The devastating earthquake of magnitude 7.8 struck Türkiye on 06 February 2023 and the strikes in the aftermath caused a huge loss with thousands of human casualties. Write a Press Release on Nepal's humanitarian support to Türkiye assuming yourself as a secretary from the Ministry of Foreign Affairs. [10]

7. Do as instructed and rewrite the sentence.

[10×1 = 10]

- a) It(can't/ might/must/) have been my wife who moved it. She has the other key. But perhaps it was stolen. (*Choose the best modal verb.*)
- b) I wonder if you could tell me how this computer works. (*Convert it into a direct question.*)
- c) 'Could you write that down for me?' she asked. (*Change it into indirect speech.*)
- d) You give respect. You get respect. (*Convert the sentences into **if** sentence.*)
- e) The internet/the extensive information/find (*Make a passive sentence with the information.*)
- f) I was having lunch. Dipam arrived (*Join the sentences with either **while** or **when**.*)
- g) He is the man. I met him at the conference (*Join the sentences with a suitable relative clause.*)
- h) When I reached the station, the train(*Fill in the blanks with a suitable verb of **leave**.*)
- i) The bird flewhis head (*Fill in the blanks with a suitable preposition: **over** /**above**/**in**.*)
- j) I (not) wear glasses when I was at university. (*Rewrite the sentence with either **used to** or **would**.*)

8. Do as instructed.

[5×1 = 5]

- a) Write the adverb form of the word **analyze**.
- b) The word '**infection**' has the correct IPA phonetic inscription:
i. /ɪn'fek.ʃən/ ii. /i:n'fek.ʃən/ iii. /ɪn'fek.sən/ iv. /i:n'fek.sən/

- c) How many syllables are in the word: **appendectomy**?
- d) I love that (antique/beautiful/ big /green) car that always parked in front of my house. (*Arrange the adjectives in the correct order to make a sensible sentence.*)
- e) Does she have enough money? (*Copy the sentence and underline the content word.*)

☞ - The End - ☞